

Then our sentence would just be 12314, using only four words where one word which is redundant is deleted and upon being called refers to the piece of information that's already available (1, in this case) – thus making the sentence smaller.



Winrar is one of the more popular data compression softwares

There are two types of compression: 'lossy' and 'lossless'. Lossless compression is the type of compression that returns the entire original file upon expansion. Lossy compression cuts down on the unnecessary bits of information, thus despite being incomplete, the file will still be entirely functional.

Now that you have a fair idea of what compression is, you'd do well to know that one of the most important applications of data compression is in data storage, of course. The amount of data we produce is continuously expanding, and this coupled with the limitations on bandwidth clearly makes data compression the need of the hour.

So yeah, our advice – use popular compression tools such as WinRAR or 7-Zip to compress your files and save up on space.

► **Back up on physical devices and the cloud**

External hard drives or USBs are very susceptible to physical damage in case of accidents or disasters. Storing on the cloud, on the other hand, poses bandwidth limits and a potential security threat to your data. So just to be safe, make sure you have both, physical as well as cloud backups of your most important files.

► **Keep your computer clean**

We're talking about infections of course. Be extremely wary of email attachments and anything else you download off the internet. Regularly scan your computer and ensure that your files are all clean before proceeding to carry out your next backup. You don't want a virus corrupting the drive you've already backed up your data to, do you?

► **Protect sensitive data**

Make sure your sensitive data and its backups are protected. You can either password protect your documents or use the encryption tools built into your OS. Also, make sure you completely destroy any media that's become